

SIMATS ENGINEERING

ASSESSMENT TOOL 3: Mock Interview

COURSE NAME: COMPUTER VISION

COURSE CODE: ITA05

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO5: *Develop computer vision applications using OpenCV for performing recognition and analysis on images and videos. (BTL 6)*

Assessment Tool Weightage: 10%

Mock Interview Questions

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1. Live Video Feed Text & Shape Overlay Design

Full Question Prompt:

You need to overlay text and shapes on a live video feed. Design your solution and explain how you would implement it efficiently, including key OpenCV functions and reasoning.

Solution & Technical Implementation:

To overlay shapes and text on a real-time frame without introducing latency, operations must be performed directly in-place on the memory buffer of each frame prior to display or encoding.

Implementation Steps & Key OpenCV Functions:

- **Frame Capture:** Use `cv2.VideoCapture()` to fetch real-time frames from a camera or stream.
- **Region Computation:** Calculate target pixel coordinates (bounding box points, label origins) based on detection logic or user inputs.
- **Shape Drawing (`cv2.rectangle`):** Draws bounding boxes around objects (`cv2.rectangle(img, pt1, pt2, color, thickness)`).
- **Point Highlights (`cv2.circle`):** Highlights point features, centroids, or keypoints (`cv2.circle(img, center, radius, color, thickness)`).
- **Boundary Drawing (`cv2.polylines`):** Draws multi-point boundaries or trajectories (`cv2.polylines(img, [pts], isClosed, color, thickness)`).
- **Text Rendering (`cv2.putText`):** Renders text labels such as Class Name, ID, Confidence score (`cv2.putText(img, text, org, fontFace, fontScale, color, thickness, lineType)`). Set `lineType=cv2.LINE_AA` for anti-aliased text.

Efficiency Considerations:

- **In-Place Modification:** Pass frames directly without making unnecessary array copies (`img.copy()`), saving memory allocation overhead.
- **Resolution Independence:** Compute overlay positions scaled to frame width and height so text and shapes remain proportional across varying resolutions.

2. Feature Detection and Visualization Approach

Full Question Prompt:

You are asked to highlight key features in an image. Design a feature detection and visualization approach, explaining the techniques and their suitability.

Solution & Technical Implementation:

Highlighting key features requires extracting distinctive image points (edges, corners, or scale-invariant visual markers) that resist changes in scale, illumination, and rotation.

Technique Selection & Suitability:

- **Corner & Point Features (FAST / ORB):** Suitable for real-time performance, low computational cost, and rotation invariance. Functions: `cv2.ORB_create()` paired with `orb.detectAndCompute()`. Visualization: `cv2.drawKeypoints()` draws circles and vector directions representing key feature scale and orientation.
- **Scale and Rotation Invariant Features (SIFT):** Suitable for high-accuracy tasks involving extreme scale shifts or occlusion. Functions: `cv2.SIFT_create()` paired with `sift.detectAndCompute()`.
- **Edge Features (Canny Edge Detection):** Suitable for structural outline identification. Functions: `cv2.Canny(image, threshold1, threshold2)`. Visualization: `cv2.bitwise_and()` overlays detected edge maps in distinct colors onto the original image canvas.

3. Visual Image Difference Comparison

Full Question Prompt:

You need to compare two images and highlight differences visually. Analyze the problem and design a solution, justifying your approach.

Solution & Technical Implementation:

Simply subtracting pixels ($\text{ImageA} - \text{ImageB}$) fails under real-world conditions due to minor alignment shifts, environmental lighting variations, and sensor noise. A robust visual comparison pipeline isolates structural changes from noise.

Implementation Steps:

- **Alignment & Grayscale Conversion:** Align images to identical dimensions and convert them to grayscale via `cv2.cvtColor()`.
- **Denoising:** Apply a Bilateral Filter (`cv2.bilateralFilter`) to smooth out high-frequency sensor noise while preserving sharp structural edges.
- **Structural & Difference Computation:** Compute Structural Similarity Index (SSIM) to evaluate structural changes, and Absolute Pixel Difference (`cv2.absdiff`) to capture magnitude changes.
- **Binarization & Cleaning:** Apply Otsu's thresholding (`cv2.threshold`) followed by morphological closing (`cv2.morphologyEx`) to merge fragmented noise into coherent change masks.
- **Visualization Overlay:** Extract change contours (`cv2.findContours`) and draw bounding boxes (`cv2.rectangle`) or a colored mask layer (`cv2.addWeighted`) over modified regions.

Justification of Approach:

Combining SSIM with morphological operations filters out ambient lighting fluctuations, restricting visual highlights strictly to real, structural object variations.

4. Analysis & Remediation of Face Detection False Positives

Full Question Prompt:

A face detection system produces multiple false positives. Analyze the issue and propose improvements, explaining how each change enhances accuracy.

Solution & Technical Implementation:

Root Cause Analysis: False positives in face detection occur when non-face background clutter (textures, shadows, wall patterns) mimics facial characteristics under static detection thresholds or fixed-scale sliding windows.

Proposed Improvements & Enhancements:

- **Increase Confidence & Intersection Thresholds:** Raise detection confidence scores and Non-Maximum Suppression (NMS) IoU thresholds. Enhancement: Eliminates weak, highly overlapping candidate boxes that capture background noise.
- **Multi-Scale Image Pyramid Tuning:** Adjust scale factors (e.g., from 1.05 to 1.2 in Haar cascades) and set realistic minimum/maximum face size constraints (minSize, maxSize). Enhancement: Prevents the detector from searching scales that are physically improbable within the camera setup.
- **Preprocessing & Contrast Normalization:** Apply CLAHE (Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization) before detection. Enhancement: Balances harsh directional lighting and extreme shadows, reducing false edge triggers.
- **Modern Model Migration:** Upgrade legacy Viola-Jones/Haar Cascades to Deep Learning-based detectors (such as RetinaFace or MediaPipe Face Detector). Enhancement: Convolutional features model complex spatial geometry better than manual Haar features, reducing false positive rates.

5. Adapting Facial Expression Recognition to Head Movements

Full Question Prompt:

A facial expression system fails with slight head movements. Analyze the limitation and propose modifications, justifying your approach.

Solution & Technical Implementation:

Root Cause Analysis: Facial expression recognition models often rely on absolute 2D landmark coordinates (e.g., distance between lips or eyes). When a user tilts or turns their head (yaw, pitch, roll), 2D distance values distort even if the expression remains unchanged.

Proposed Modifications & Justification:

- **Pose Normalization via Affine Alignment:** Estimate 2D/3D facial landmarks (MediaPipe Face Mesh), compute an alignment matrix based on eye/nose anchors, and apply an affine transform (`cv2.getAffineTransform` / `cv2.warpAffine`) to warp the face into a canonical frontal view before classification. Justification: Removes head pose variations (yaw/roll), presenting the model with a standardized frontal face.
- **Relative Geometry & Normalized Ratios:** Instead of absolute pixel distances, calculate normalized Euclidean distances relative to fixed facial baselines (e.g., lip stretch distance divided by inter-ocular distance). Justification: Keeps feature metrics scale- and pose-invariant across dynamic movement.
- **3D Facial Mesh Integration:** Replace 2D landmark tracking with 3D landmark tracking. Justification: 3D coordinates preserve spatial depth during head rotation, preventing perspective compression from skewing facial muscle measurements.